Bayan G. Balt

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Atty. Bayan G. Balt

Bayan G. Balt (born December 23, 1953) is a lawyer and civic leader from Bayang, Lanao del Sur. He is the great-grandson of the Sultan of Bayang and Sultan Pandapatan, the two Maranao Muslim leaders who commanded forces in the May 2, 1902 Battle of Bayang against United States military forces. Since 1995, Balt has served as legal counsel on the environment for the Moro National Liberation Front (MNLF). His professional roles have included regional appointments in labor, legal practice, leadership of multiple civil society organizations, and participation in international peace agreement reviews and conferences.

Early Life and Family Background

Bayan G. Balt was born on December 23, 1953, in Barangay Bairan, Bayang, Lanao del Sur, to parents Abdullah A. Balt, a former Municipal Vice Mayor, and Za-alika G. Goling-Balt. He is the great-grandson of the Sultan of Bayang and Sultan Pandapatan, the two Maranao Muslim leaders who led the Filipino Muslims in the May 2, 1902 Battle of Bayang (also known as the Battle of Padang Karbala). This battle was fought against the United States 32nd cavalry forces under Colonel Frank Baldwin and General John "Black Jack" Pershing. According to the profile, this battle was recorded in U.S. history as the fiercest battle in the history of the entire Philippine insurrection.

Balt is married to Mrs. Annamilly Pangarungan Alug-Balt. They have five children: Atty. Anzarullah Zhadradi A. Abdullah, Atty. Princess Shanihar A. Abdullah, Atty. Shayma A. Abdullah, Dra. Arabecca Shania A. Abdullah, and Mr. Abdulbayan Shevardnadze A. Abdullah.

Education and Legal Training

Balt earned a Bachelor of Arts in Political Science from MLQ University in Manila between 1970 and 1973 as a consistent National Intellectual Scholarship Program (NISGP) Scholar. He then earned a Bachelor of Laws from the same institution between 1974 and 1977, also as a NISGP Scholar. He was a graduate of the Philippine Shari'a Training Institute at Mindanao State University (MSU Marawi City) from 1981 to 1982.

On April 8, 1978, Balt was admitted to the Philippine Bar by the Supreme Court to practice law in the Philippines. His Roll of Attorney number is 28131.

Legal Career and Law Practice

Balt worked as a Senior Lawyer at the Department of Agrarian Reform, Marawi City District Office from 1978 to 1980. He was a Senior Partner at the Pangadapun, Mamondiong, Balt, Barambangan and Madum Law Firm in Marawi City from 1980 to 1986. In 2000, he became a Senior Partner of the Balt, Abdullah, Abdullah and Abdullah Law Offices at 122 Quezon Avenue in Marawi City, a position he has held to the present.

Since 1982, Balt has served as Provincial Coordinator of the Free Legal Assistance Group (FLAG), described in the source as a group of lawyers that assist the poor, weak and defenseless in Lanao del Sur.

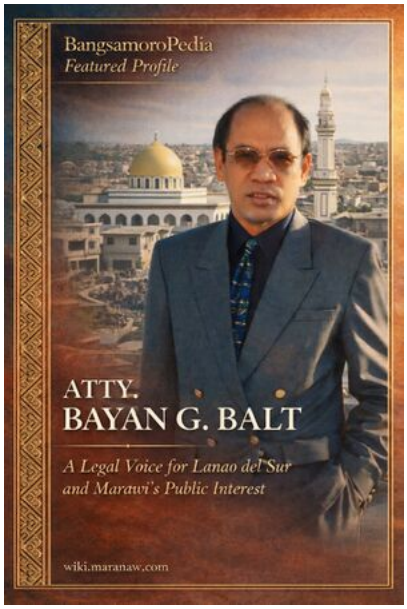
He filed four environmental suits against corporations: National Power Corporation, TRANSCO, and PSALM. These cases (Civil Cases No. 1918-03, 1546-05, 1619-06, and ERC case No. 221-2002, EIA case No. 2004-001) involved issues of electricity pricing, damages, non-payment of taxes, and protections of consumers and people living around Lake Lanao. According to the source, these cases are terminated and for resolutions by courts.

Balt has hosted the "Lawyer's Forum, Views and Interviews" on Local Television Channel 13 (simulcast on Channel 1 Marawi Cable and radio DXKC in Marawi City) from 2013 to the present.

Political and Civic Leadership

Balt was appointed Regional Assemblyman (Lupong Tagapagpagapanap ng Pook, or LTP) of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) by former Senator Nene Q. Pimentel Jr., then Minister of Local Government, from 1986 to 1988.

He was appointed Regional Cabinet Secretary of the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE-ARMM) in Cotabato City by former Governor Nur P. Misuari from 1997 to 1999. From 1998 to 1999, he was awarded "Most Outstanding Public Official" while serving in this position, sponsored by the Manila Bulletin and the Newsmen Association of the Philippines.



Bayan G. Balt	
Born	December 23, 1953, Barangay Bairan, Bayang, Lanao del Sur
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Education	Bachelor of Arts in Political Science (MLQ University), Bachelor of Laws (MLQ University), Shari'a Training (MSU Marawi City)
Bar Admission	April 8, 1978, Philippine Bar
Spouse	Annamilly Pangarungan Alug-Balt
Children	5 (three lawyers, one physician, one computer graduate)
Occupation	Lawyer, diplomat, civic leader
Notable Roles	MNLF Legal Counsel (since 1995), President IBP Marawi City (2013-2015), Chairman RFMS (2017-date), National President CAMP (2002-present)

Balt has held positions of leadership in several organizations:

Ranao Movement Against Corruptions & Crime (RMACC) - Chairman/led Convenor. The source describes it as a group of NGOs and Civil Society dedicated to eradicate corruptions in Mindanao.

Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP), Marawi City & Lanao Del Sur Chapter - President from 2013 to 2015.

Ranao Federal State Movement (RFSM) - Chairman, Iligan City, from 2017 to the present.

PDP-LABAN, Lanao Del Sur Chapter - Provincial Chairman (on leave), under former Senate President Aquilino "Nene" Q. Pimentel Jr., since 1982 to the present.

Mindanao Council, Bansang Nagkaisa sa Diwa at Layunin (BANDILA) - Chairman.

Christians And Muslims for Peace (CAMP), Philippine Chapter - National President from 2002 to the present. The source states that CAMP was founded at the Crystal Cathedral Church in Garden Grove, California, and aims to promote peace and better understanding including interfaith dialogue between Muslims and Christians.

Alliance of Regional Coalitions Against People's Poverty (ARCAPP) - National Chairman from 2005 to the present. The source describes it as a coalition of 32 NGOs and Civil Society Organizations located in Cagayan de Oro City.

Diplomatic and International Engagement

As Regional Secretary of Labor and Employment in ARMM (1997–1999), Balt undertook diplomatic missions regarding labor and worker issues.

In 1998, he was sent to Sabah, Malaysia to prevent the untimely deportation of some 450,000 undocumented Filipino workers. According to the source, he held meetings with Abu Talib Harun, Officer In-charge of Immigration at the Ministry of Home Affairs. Upon his request, the deportation of undocumented workers was deferred for at least three years.

In 1999, he was sent to Riyadh, Saudi Arabia to negotiate for the return of 64 Filipino workers stranded at the Philippine Embassy in Riyadh who could not return to the Philippines due to refusal of their employers to issue exit visas. He held a meeting with Mohammad Al-Shanani, then Saudi Arabia's Minister of Labor and Social Affairs, who granted the issuance of exit visas to the 64 stranded Filipino workers, thus paving the way for their return to the Philippines.

Also in 1999, he launched the "Job for Peace 2000" to request from Arab and Muslim Ministers of Labor to allocate at least ten percent of their jobs order for Muslim Mindanao. The source states that he held meetings with Minister Matar Humaid Al Tair of the Arab Emirates, Mohammad Al-Shanani of Saudi Arabia, and Sheikh Fallah Al-Thani of Qatar. These officials granted his request to hire workers from Muslim Mindanao.

From 1998 to 1999, as ARMM Labor Chief, he led a Labor and Investment mission to Southeast Asia and the Middle East. In Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, he conferred with officials of the Malaysian Manufacturers Association. In Jeddah, Saudi Arabia, he held meetings with the Jeddah Chamber of Commerce and Industry. In Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, he met with the Chairman of the Saudi Recruitment Agency. In Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates, he held talks with top officials of the Abu Dhabi Chamber of Commerce and Industry. In Doha, Qatar, he met with top major recruitment and employers agencies. The source states that the mission brought investment awareness and improved ARMM's rating as an investment haven in these countries.

Between 1998 and 1999, while chairman of the Regional Tripartite Wage and Productivity Board (RTWPB) in the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao, Balt increased the wages of ARMM workers twice, for the first time during this period.

Peace Process and Legal Counsel

Since 1995, Balt has served as Legal Counsel on Environment for the Moro National Liberation Front (MNLF). He participated as counsel and member of the Tripartite Review Process in 2007 that reviewed the 1996 Final Peace Agreement between the Government of the Philippines (GPH), the MNLF, and the Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC). He also served as counsel and member of the final Tripartite Review Process of the 1996 Final Peace Agreement held in Jeddah, Saudi Arabia, from January 25 to 27, 2016.

In May 2016, during the national and local elections, Balt served as Coalition Chief Legal Counsel of all supporters, movements and organizations of Duterte in ARMM, including the PPRD, Hugpong Federalismo, MRRD-NECC, and NUIMD.

Balt attended the 4th World Peace Forum held in Bogor, West Java, Indonesia, from November 23 to 25, 2012, as an official delegate of the MNLF delegation. He was also a participant in the GRP-MNLF-OIC review of the 1996 Final Peace Agreement held in Bandung, Republic of Indonesia, in March 2012.

International Advocacy and Speaking Engagements

Balt has participated in several international conferences. In October 2000, he was a keynote speaker at the 3rd International Conference on Peace and Understanding held at the Campus of the Crystal Cathedral Ministry in Garden Grove, California.

In July 2004, he delivered a paper entitled "The Environmental Case of Lake Lanao" during the 10th World Environmental Conference held at the Boston Towers Plaza Hotel in Boston, Massachusetts.

In March 2005, he was a speaker at the 9th Cairo International Conference on Energy and Environment held at the Pyramisa Resort Hotel in Sharm El-Sheik, Egypt, on the topic "The Agus hydroelectric power plants and the Environment of Lake Lanao."

In June 2005, he served as a resource speaker at the 32nd annual meeting of the Council of Foreign Ministers of the Organization of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) held in Sana'a, Republic of Yemen, speaking on the topic "Lake Lanao, a nature's gift to the Maranaos."

Balt was an official delegate to the 33rd meeting of the Council of Foreign Ministers of the Organization of Islamic Cooperation held in Baku, Republic of Azerbaijan, from June 23 to 26, 2007. He also attended the Council's 41st meeting held in Kuwait City from May 26 to 28, 2015.

International Travel

According to his profile, Balt has visited Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Kuwait, Bahrain, United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Republic of Yemen, Republic of Azerbaijan, India, Thailand, People's Republic of China, Taiwan, Hong Kong, South Korea, Japan, Singapore, Indonesia, Malaysia, and San Francisco, Los Angeles, and New York in the United States.

Academic and Professional Affiliations

Balt is a member of the Beta Sigma Lambda Exclusive Law Fraternity since 1974.

Recognition and Awards

Balt was awarded "Most Outstanding Public Official" in 1998-1999 while serving as Regional Secretary of the Department of Labor and Employment in ARMM, an award sponsored by the Manila Bulletin and the Newsmen Association of the Philippines.

Roles and Positions

Balt's career has included simultaneous leadership of multiple organizations. Since 1995, he has served as Legal Counsel on Environment for the MNLF. He has held the position of Provincial Coordinator of FLAG since 1982, and served as President of the IBP Marawi City & Lanao Del Sur Chapter from 2013 to 2015. He has been a senior partner in private law practice since 2000 and has hosted a legal affairs television program since 2013.

Further Reading

- Office of the Presidential Adviser on the Peace Process (OPAPP). *Records of the Tripartite Review Process, 1996 Final Peace Agreement*. Government of the Philippines.
- Integrated Bar of the Philippines. *IBP Marawi City & Lanao Del Sur Chapter Records*. 2013–2015.
- Free Legal Assistance Group (FLAG). *Regional Coordinators Directory*. Lanao del Sur Office.

See Also

- Battle of Bayang
- Moro National Liberation Front
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- 1996 Final Peace Agreement
- Lake Lanao
- Bangsamoro Peace Process
- Christians and Muslims for Peace
- Maranao people

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